TOOL 1 • GOVERNANCE & VELOCITY

Decision Architecture & Rights Matrix

The Rule of the Single "A": *There are no consensus votes and no split accountabilities. One person owns the decision ("A"). Peer input is heard ("C"), but the Accountable leader decides. If anyone disagrees, they escalate with a clear recommendation.*

DECISION TIER DEFINITIONS

Tier 1 • Operational: Daily frontline execution within published guardrails. No management permission needed.

Tier 2 • Managerial: Process changes, inter-departmental handoffs, or resource allocations that impact workflow.

Tier 3 • Strategic: High-risk structural shifts, organizational realignments, or critical customer/financial commitments.

DECISION DESCRIPTION & SCOPE	TIER (1-3)	THE SINGLE "A" (ACCOUNTABLE)	CONSULTED ("C") & INFORMED ("I")	PREREQUISITES / WHAT MUST BE TRUE TO DECIDE	TARGET DATE & ESCALATION
Example: Project Intake Prioritization	TIER 2	VP of Operations (Sole owner of stack-rank)	**C:** Engineering Lead, Product Lead **I:** Executive Staff	Capacity audit complete; trade-off identified using Kill Switch.	Every Monday, 9:00 AM *Escalate to CEO if tied*
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Rollout Standard: Publish this matrix in your department's shared workspace. Review weekly. When a decision stalls, ask: *"Who is the single 'A' in the room?"* Let them make the call.

Department Executive Sign-Off
Date Published & Reinforced